Malawi's cost of money, the region, and the month ahead

Malawi's Treasury bills up front, then ten African markets, the ASBI and currencies. Compiled 19 Oct 2026 from the Reserve Bank of Malawi's auction results and nine other central banks.

EDITION

October 2026

FIGURES AS OF

19 October 2026

DOCUMENT

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1 Malawi: Treasury bills

Average yield · Reserve Bank of Malawi

16.00%	−12.37	1.01×	20 Oct
364-day, 29 Sept 2026	Real yield after inflation (2025)	Bids to amount accepted, last 90 days	Next result expected

Exhibit 1. **Malawi Treasury bill rates, with changes in basis points**

TENOR	RATE	1M	1Y	12 MONTHS	LATEST
91-day	12.00%	±0	−400		29 Sept 2026
182-day	14.50%	−50	−550		29 Sept 2026
364-day	16.00%	±0	−1000		29 Sept 2026

The rate is the average yield of allotted bids.

Source: Reserve Bank of Malawi, auction results. As of 29 September 2026.

What it means for MWK 1,000,000

Put MWK 1,000,000 into the 364-day bill at this auction and you get back MWK 1,160,000 after 12 months: MWK 160,000 in interest before any withholding tax, about MWK 13,333 a month. That is the same as at the previous auction.

Malawi in the ASBI

Malawi ranks 2 of 10 markets by one-year rate, contributing 16.00% against an index of 12.37% (week of 19 Oct 2026).

The MWK against the dollar

1733.60 per dollar on 19 Oct 2026, +0.80% over the month (positive means stronger).

2 Ten African markets

As of 19 Oct 2026

Exhibit 2. Treasury bill rates in ten markets, with one-month changes in basis points

MARKET	91-DAY	1M	182-DAY	1M	364-DAY	1M	364-DAY, 12 MONTHS	LATEST
Egypt	23.83%	−72	24.95%	−70	25.67%	+40		13 Oct 2026
Ghana	4.62%	−7	6.32%	−20	9.71%	−39		19 Oct 2026
Kenya	8.75%	−2	8.86%	−7	9.04%	−3		19 Oct 2026
Malawi	**12.00%**	**±0**	**14.50%**	**−50**	**16.00%**	**±0**		**29 Sept 2026**
Mozambique	12.18%	−1	12.15%	−2	12.09%	±0		14 Oct 2026
Nigeria	15.50%	−80	15.80%	−70	15.85%	−77		14 Oct 2026
South Africa	7.14%	+31	7.47%	+12	7.53%	+20		12 Oct 2026
Tanzania	3.49%	+7	5.63%	+70	6.28%	−19		7 Oct 2026
Uganda	9.70%	−5	10.75%	+75	11.50%	+50		1 Oct 2026
Zambia	8.50%	−50	9.10%	−95	10.00%	−90		15 Oct 2026

Source: Central banks of each market, auction results. As of 19 October 2026.

Exhibit 3. Real yields on one-year bills

MARKET	364-DAY	INFLATION	REAL
Egypt	25.67%	14.1% 2025	+11.60
Uganda	11.50%	3.6% 2025	+7.92
Mozambique	12.09%	4.4% 2025	+7.72
Kenya	9.04%	4.1% 2025	+4.97
South Africa	7.53%	3.2% 2025	+4.32
Tanzania	6.28%	3.3% 2025	+2.96
Zambia	10.00%	13.9% 2025	−3.91
Ghana	9.71%	14.2% 2025	−4.49
Nigeria	15.85%	23.0% 2025	−7.16
Malawi	**16.00%**	**28.4%** 2025	**−12.37**

Source: Central banks; World Bank. As of 19 October 2026.

Exhibit 4. Afronomics African Sovereign Bill Index: 12.37%, ±0 bps on the week

#	MARKET	364-DAY	W/W	DATE
1	Egypt	25.67%	±0	13 Oct 2026
2	**Malawi**	**16.00%**	**±0**	**29 Sept 2026**
3	Nigeria	15.85%	±0	7 Oct 2026
4	Mozambique	12.09%	±0	7 Oct 2026
5	Uganda	11.50%	±0	1 Oct 2026
6	Zambia	10.00%	±0	15 Oct 2026
7	Ghana	9.71%	−4	19 Oct 2026
8	Kenya	9.04%	±0	19 Oct 2026
9	South Africa	7.53%	±0	12 Oct 2026
10	Tanzania	6.28%	±0	7 Oct 2026

Source: Afronomics ASBI, from central banks' auction results. As of 19 October 2026.

3 Currencies and the month ahead

Exhibit 5. Against the US dollar, one month

CURRENCY	NOW	MONTH AGO	CHANGE
Kenya shilling KES	129.79	129.68	−0.08%
Nigerian naira NGN	1331.62	1327.24	−0.33%
South African rand ZAR	16.4619	16.4069	−0.33%
Ghanaian cedi GHS	11.6540	11.7012	+0.40%
Egyptian pound EGP	53.5247	52.0920	−2.68%
Ugandan shilling UGX	4060.88	3830.61	−5.67%
Tanzanian shilling TZS	2632.13	2615.17	−0.64%
Zambian kwacha ZMW	20.1552	19.5612	−2.95%
Malawian kwacha MWK	**1733.60**	**1747.53**	**+0.80%**
Mozambican metical MZN	63.6538	63.7815	+0.20%
Rwandan franc RWF	1475.49	1476.65	+0.08%
Ethiopian birr ETB	161.53	162.45	+0.57%
West African CFA franc XOF	584.37	578.23	−1.05%
Moroccan dirham MAD	9.7266	9.6647	−0.64%

Positive change means the currency strengthened against the dollar.

Source: Daily mid-market reference rates, archived by Afronomics. As of 19 October 2026.

Exhibit 6. Next auction results expected

MARKET	EXPECTED	RHYTHM
South Africa	19 Oct 2026	every 7 days · last 12 Oct
Mozambique	19 Oct 2026	every 1 days · last 14 Oct
Egypt	20 Oct 2026	every 7 days · last 13 Oct
Malawi	**20 Oct 2026**	**every 7 days · last 29 Sept**
Tanzania	21 Oct 2026	every 14 days · last 7 Oct
Kenya	26 Oct 2026	every 7 days · last 19 Oct
Ghana	26 Oct 2026	every 7 days · last 19 Oct
Nigeria	28 Oct 2026	every 14 days · last 14 Oct
Uganda	29 Oct 2026	every 14 days · last 1 Oct
Zambia	29 Oct 2026	every 14 days · last 15 Oct

Projected from each central bank's auction rhythm, not an official calendar.

Source: Afronomics, from central banks' auction results. As of 19 October 2026.

Method, sources and how to cite

Method

The rate is the average yield of allotted bids, as the Reserve Bank of Malawi publishes it. One-month and one-year changes compare the latest auction with the auction closest to one month and one year earlier.

Real yields are the latest 364-day rate less the latest annual consumer price inflation published by the World Bank. Demand is the median, over the last 90 days, of bids received as a multiple of the amount offered.

The Afronomics African Sovereign Bill Index (ASBI) is the equal-weighted average of each market's latest one-year rate; its method is published at afronomicsfeed.com/markets/bill-index.

Expected auction dates come from each central bank's auction rhythm, not an official calendar.

Sources

1. Reserve Bank of Malawi, Treasury bill auction results. afronomicsfeed.com/markets/tbills/malawi
2. Central banks of the ten markets, auction results. afronomicsfeed.com/markets/tbills
3. World Bank, consumer price inflation, annual. data.worldbank.org
4. Daily US dollar reference rates, archived by Afronomics. afronomicsfeed.com/markets

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How to cite

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Corrections

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